01

Source audit, syllabus boundary and package counts

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Mandatory source order followed: complete Topic 03 owner -> Basic/Core owner -> Advanced owner -> Polity README, official-syllabus mapping, command index, answer-worthiness audit and PYQ ledgers -> direct text extraction from both local OCR-searchable M.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Laxmikanth PDFs -> live official/reliable verification only for dated claims.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Official syllabus ownership: Mains GS-II "Indian Constitution — features" and "separation of powers"; Prelims GS-I Indian Polity and Governance.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Demand-only ledger entries are never reconstructed into fictional options.

ANSWER LINE: Mandatory source order followed: complete Topic 03 owner -> Basic/Core owner -> Advanced owner -> Polity README, official-syllabus mapping, command index, answer-worthiness audit and PYQ ledgers -> direct text extraction from both local OCR-searchable M.

02

Live-source decisions — checked 21 August 2026

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] 106th Amendment: Gazette S.O.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

1922(E), 16 April 2026, verifies commencement. [LIMIT] Commencement is not operational reservation; Article 334A requires the census-publication and delimitation sequence.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

No implementation election or seat projection is asserted.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

1922(E), 16 April 2026, verifies commencement. [LIMIT] Commencement is not operational reservation; Article 334A requires the census-publication and delimitation sequence.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] 106th Amendment: Gazette S.O.

03

Answer-line control register

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

01: A salient constitutional feature is a system-level design characteristic produced by the interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

01: A salient constitutional feature is a system-level design characteristic produced by the interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

09: An integrated and independent judiciary supplies national legal unity and makes constitutional supremacy effective through review and remedies.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

11: Indian secularism protects equal citizenship and freedom of conscience through principled state engagement, not a theocratic order or an absolute wall of separation.

ANSWER LINE: These sentences are controlled exam formulations.

04

What counts as a salient constitutional feature

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (OPENING DEFINITION): A salient constitutional feature is a system-level design characteristic produced by the interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (OPENING DEFINITION): A salient constitutional feature is a system-level design characteristic produced by the interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!What counts as a salient constitutional feature

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[LIMIT] 'Salient features' is a teaching classification, not a closed constitutional schedule.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (OPENING DEFINITION): A salient constitutional feature is a system-level design characteristic produced by the interaction of provisions, institutions, values and practice.

05

Written, lengthy and detailed Constitution

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): India's written detail is an accommodation device: it constitutionalises diversity and administration, while remaining dependent on conventions, interpretation and implementation.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[FACT] India has a written, comprehensive and unusually detailed Constitution because it combines fundamental rules with substantial administrative design for a vast and diverse Union.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Written, lengthy and detailed Constitution

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[LIMIT] 'Lengthiest' is a comparative textbook description, not a licence to quote an unsourced current Article count.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): India's written detail is an accommodation device: it constitutionalises diversity and administration, while remaining dependent on conventions, interpretation and implementation.

06

Borrowed sources as adaptation, not copying

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): The Constitution is borrowed in ancestry but original in design because the framers selected, adapted and rejected foreign devices to serve Indian conditions.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): The Constitution is borrowed in ancestry but original in design because the framers selected, adapted and rejected foreign devices to serve Indian conditions.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Borrowed sources as adaptation, not copying

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] The Constitution drew from multiple constitutional traditions and the 1935 Act, but the exam-worthy point is selective adaptation to Indian conditions rather than a catalogue of foreign origins.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): The Constitution is borrowed in ancestry but original in design because the framers selected, adapted and rejected foreign devices to serve Indian conditions.

07

Blend of rigidity and flexibility

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): India's graded amendment system combines adaptability with entrenchment, while the basic-structure doctrine prevents constitutional change from becoming constitutional destruction.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[FACT] The amendment design combines ordinary legislative change, special parliamentary majorities and, for specified federal matters, ratification by at least half of the States.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[FACT] India is neither as flexible as the classic British model nor as rigid as the United States model.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[ANALYSIS] The basic-structure doctrine creates a tension between democratic updating and constitutional identity: amendment is broad, not destructive.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): India's graded amendment system combines adaptability with entrenchment, while the basic-structure doctrine prevents constitutional change from becoming constitutional destruction.

08

Federal system with centralising, cooperative and asymmetric dimensions

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India is a federation in structure with constitutionally strong Union capacity; its operation also includes cooperative, competitive and asymmetric forms of federalism.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The Union was not created by a compact among sovereign States, and States have no right to secede.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Federal system with centralising, cooperative and asymmetric dimensions

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] Article 1 calls India a 'Union of States'; the Constitution does not use 'Federation'.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Indian federalism distributes power to accommodate diversity, but retains centralising, cooperative and asymmetric devices so the Union can coordinate without erasing the States.

09

Parliamentary government and responsible executive

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India adopts parliamentary government at Union and State levels: a nominal constitutional head works with a real Council of Ministers collectively responsible to the elected lower House.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[FACT] India adopts parliamentary government at Union and State levels: a nominal constitutional head works with a real Council of Ministers collectively responsible to the elected lower House.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Wrong: Responsible government guarantees effective scrutiny.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[LIMIT] Indian Parliament is not sovereign like Westminster.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Parliamentary government makes the executive continuously responsible to the elected lower House, although disciplined majorities can turn legislative confidence into executive dominance.

10

Synthesis of parliamentary power, judicial review and constitutional supremacy

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India borrows the British idea of a powerful Parliament and the American idea of judicial review, but places both inside a written and supreme Constitution.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The exam-safe formulation is constitutional supremacy enforced partly through judicial review.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Parliamentary power, judicial review and constitutional supremacy

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Answer-use: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): India combines Parliament's broad legislative and constituent powers with judicial review under a supreme Constitution, making neither Parliament nor the judiciary sovereign in the British or American sense.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): India combines Parliament's broad legislative and constituent powers with judicial review under a supreme Constitution, making neither Parliament nor the judiciary sovereign in the British or American sense.

11

Separation of powers through checks and balances

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India does not adopt strict separation; it differentiates core functions while permitting overlap and reciprocal checks.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

!Separation of powers through checks and balances

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Separation of powers through checks and balances

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] India does not adopt strict separation; it differentiates core functions while permitting overlap and reciprocal checks.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): India separates core functions without isolating organs; constitutional overlaps are legitimate only when reciprocal checks prevent concentration of power.

12

Constitutional supremacy, rule of law and limited government

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] The Constitution is the superior source of public authority; rule of law and judicially enforceable limits distinguish constitutional government from merely popular or legislative government.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[ANALYSIS] Constitutional government both creates and restrains power.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Constitutional supremacy, rule of law and limited government

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[ANALYSIS] Law and liberty are not simple opposites.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Constitutional supremacy converts political power into legally bounded authority: every organ must show competence, fair procedure and respect for enforceable rights.

13

Independent, integrated judiciary and judicial review

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India has one integrated judicial hierarchy administering Union and State law, designed to remain institutionally independent and to enforce constitutional supremacy.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): An integrated and independent judiciary supplies national legal unity and makes constitutional supremacy effective through review and remedies.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): An integrated and independent judiciary supplies national legal unity and makes constitutional supremacy effective through review and remedies.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[LIMIT] Judicial independence is institutional impartiality, not absence of accountability, criticism or constitutional limits.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): An integrated and independent judiciary supplies national legal unity and makes constitutional supremacy effective through review and remedies.

14

Rights, Directive Principles and Duties as normative architecture

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] Parts III, IV and IV-A combine enforceable liberty, governance directives for social transformation and citizen duties; their constitutional roles differ but their purposes interact.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Fundamental Rights restrain power, Directive Principles direct social transformation and Fundamental Duties express civic responsibility; constitutional balance requires harmony without erasing their different legal status.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Legislation may give concrete legal effect, but the source and legal status must be identified.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

They are not absolute, and not every right belongs only to citizens.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Fundamental Rights restrain power, Directive Principles direct social transformation and Fundamental Duties express civic responsibility; constitutional balance requires harmony without erasing their different legal status.

15

Secular, socialist, democratic republic; dignity and fraternity

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] India is a sovereign socialist secular democratic republic; the words 'socialist', 'secular' and 'integrity' were inserted in the Preamble by the 42nd Amendment in 1976, while related constitutional commitments pre-dated the insertion.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Indian secularism protects equal citizenship and freedom of conscience through principled state engagement, not a theocratic order or an absolute wall of separation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Secular, socialist, democratic republic; dignity and fraternity

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Indian secularism protects equal citizenship and freedom of conscience through principled state engagement, not a theocratic order or an absolute wall of separation.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Indian secularism protects equal citizenship and freedom of conscience through principled state engagement, not a theocratic order or an absolute wall of separation.

16

Universal adult franchise, representative democracy and bicameralism

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] Universal adult franchise established equal political membership from the Constitution's commencement, while representative institutions and bicameralism channel that equality into government.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Correct: It was 21, reduced to 18 by the 61st Amendment.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Universal adult franchise, representative democracy and bicameralism

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] Adopting universal franchise amid poverty, inequality and low literacy was a transformative commitment to political equality, not a later reward for social development.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Universal adult franchise constitutionalised equal political membership from the beginning, while representative institutions translate that equality into accountable government.

17

Single citizenship, administrative/legal unity and All-India Services

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] A federal distribution of government coexists with single Indian citizenship, an integrated judiciary, common constitutional institutions and All-India Services, creating substantial administrative and legal unity.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[FACT] All-India Services are a distinctive bridge: officers are recruited through a common system and serve under both Union and State arrangements.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[FACT] Unlike the United States model of dual citizenship, the Constitution provides single Indian citizenship despite a dual polity.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Single citizenship, integrated courts and All-India Services create administrative and legal unity within, not instead of, a federal polity.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Single citizenship, integrated courts and All-India Services create administrative and legal unity within, not instead of, a federal polity.

18

Independent constitutional bodies and accountability ecosystem

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] The Constitution disperses integrity functions among specialised bodies so elections, audit, recruitment and fiscal distribution are not left to the ordinary executive alone.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

[FACT] These are constitutional bodies, unlike institutions created only by statute or executive resolution.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[FACT] These are constitutional bodies, unlike institutions created only by statute or executive resolution.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] The Constitution disperses integrity functions among specialised bodies so elections, audit, recruitment and fiscal distribution are not left to the ordinary executive alone.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Independent constitutional bodies disperse integrity functions outside ordinary executive control, but functional independence must coexist with transparency, reasons and review.

19

Emergency provisions and constitutional modes

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] Emergency provisions allow exceptional centralisation and altered rights/fiscal operation under specified conditions; they are constitutional powers subject to textual procedure and post-1975 safeguards.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

It enables temporary centralisation without formally rewriting the federal Constitution.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Their triggers and effects are not interchangeable.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Emergency provisions permit temporary constitutional centralisation for crisis management, but they do not authorise permanent unitary rule or extra-constitutional government.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): Emergency provisions permit temporary constitutional centralisation for crisis management, but they do not authorise permanent unitary rule or extra-constitutional government.

20

Local self-government, social justice and affirmative action

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] Democratic decentralisation and affirmative-action provisions deepen representative equality; the present constitutional third tier is primarily a later constitutionalisation through the 73rd and 74th Amendments.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): The 73rd and 74th Amendments deepened democracy by constitutionalising a third tier, yet real decentralisation still depends on functions, funds and functionaries.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Local self-government, social justice and affirmative action

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[ANALYSIS] Formal third-tier status does not guarantee autonomy.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): The 73rd and 74th Amendments deepened democracy by constitutionalising a third tier, yet real decentralisation still depends on functions, funds and functionaries.

21

Cooperative societies as constitutionalised democratic association

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] The 97th Amendment inserted cooperative societies into Article 19(1)(c), added Article 43B and inserted Part IX-B.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Correct: Its operation is bounded by the judgment and legislative competence.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Cooperative-society constitutional status

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT][LIVE OFFICIAL — checked 21 August 2026] The Supreme Court judgment remains the controlling legal position: Article 19(1)(c) and Article 43B survive, while Part IX-B cannot govern State cooperatives in the invalidated field; the Union retains competence over multi-State cooperative societies.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (FEDERAL LIMIT): The cooperative-society provisions constitutionalise voluntary and democratic association, while federal competence limits Part IX-B's operation for State cooperatives.

22

Asymmetry, language, pluralism and accommodation of diversity

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] The Constitution combines common citizenship with differentiated territorial, tribal, cultural and linguistic arrangements; unity is pursued through accommodation as well as uniform rules.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional asymmetry uses differentiated territorial, tribal, cultural and linguistic arrangements to pursue integration through accommodation rather than coerced uniformity.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Asymmetry, language, pluralism and accommodation of diversity

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional asymmetry uses differentiated territorial, tribal, cultural and linguistic arrangements to pursue integration through accommodation rather than coerced uniformity.

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23

Continuity, transformation, strengths and internal tensions

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] The Government of India Act, 1935 contributed institutional and administrative continuity, but the Constitution changed the source and ends of authority through republicanism, universal franchise, rights and accountable government.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (TRANSFORMATION VERDICT): The Constitution retained administrative machinery from colonial rule but transformed its legitimacy through popular sovereignty, rights, universal franchise and responsible government.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Continuity, transformation, strengths and internal tensions

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[FACT] Constitutional morality, in Ambedkar's use drawing on George Grote, concerns disciplined respect for constitutional forms, methods and values rather than personal or majoritarian morality.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (TRANSFORMATION VERDICT): The Constitution retained administrative machinery from colonial rule but transformed its legitimacy through popular sovereignty, rights, universal franchise and responsible government.

24

Constitutional morality as the operating ethic

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional morality is fidelity to constitutional forms, values and restraint; it must discipline power through text and structure rather than become a label for personal preference.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional morality is fidelity to constitutional forms, values and restraint; it must discipline power through text and structure rather than become a label for personal preference.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Constitutional morality as operating ethic

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional morality is fidelity to constitutional forms, values and restraint; it must discipline power through text and structure rather than become a label for personal preference.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (ANALYTICAL TRANSITION): Constitutional morality is fidelity to constitutional forms, values and restraint; it must discipline power through text and structure rather than become a label for personal preference.

25

Eighth-edition integration: constitution, constitutional law and constitutionalism

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): A Constitution creates public power, constitutional law governs it and constitutionalism asks whether effective limits, accountability and remedies actually operate.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): A Constitution creates public power, constitutional law governs it and constitutionalism asks whether effective limits, accountability and remedies actually operate.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): A Constitution creates public power, constitutional law governs it and constitutionalism asks whether effective limits, accountability and remedies actually operate.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[LIMIT] Classification is an analytical tool, not constitutional text.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CORE ARGUMENT): A Constitution creates public power, constitutional law governs it and constitutionalism asks whether effective limits, accountability and remedies actually operate.

26

Criticisms, counterarguments, cross-topic boundaries and final verdict

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[LIMIT] Rights, DPSP and Duties doctrine -> Topics 07-09.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CRITICISM): The Constitution's tensions are not design failures by definition; they become failures when central capacity defeats federalism, majority rule defeats rights or institutional independence escapes accountability.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[LIMIT] Rights, DPSP and Duties doctrine -> Topics 07-09.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CRITICISM): The Constitution's tensions are not design failures by definition; they become failures when central capacity defeats federalism, majority rule defeats rights or institutional independence escapes accountability.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM (CRITICISM): The Constitution's tensions are not design failures by definition; they become failures when central capacity defeats federalism, majority rule defeats rights or institutional independence escapes accountability.